4. Deadline undercutting

Read every advertised deadline, then declare one step earlier than all of them.

Advertised at K

Peer	Deadline
H1	now + 11.4 s
H2	now + 12.8 s
H3	now + 13.8 s
A	now + 11.4 s − 1 ulp

undercut the earliest →

Leader election

earliest deadline wins

A leads; A admits whom it likes

Cost to A: one identity,
no compute, no crafted node ID

One ulp is 2.4×10^{-7} s here · enough to win the comparison, no advertisement life lost